

“ Why Generation Y Has It The Best”

From year to year life never seems to change. Perhaps this is because individuals only notices their lifetime and do not focus on those older or younger than themselves. However, if individuals are placed within certain generations, the differences become apparent. As of the year 2000, there are three main generations. First are the people of age 55 to 102, second are the people 30-55, and third are the people 15-30. This last generation is labeled generation Y and in comparison has it the best. Where generation Y has the best opportunity for most everything, it especially exceeds in opportunities for shopping, dating, and popular entertainment. These things at first glance may not seem to lend them selves to having a generational advantage, but indeed they do.

Shopping is a somewhat overlooked part of society. The youth of today has the best conditions for clothing shopping in history. For the grandparents of the youth of today, shopping was extremely simple. Generally, the parents would go to the store, buy whatever style and size clothing needed and give it to the child to wear. For the parents of the youth of today, shopping was very similar as grandparents. The only major change was that parents often brought the children along to pick clothing they desired. This in itself was quite new, as styles started emerging and fashion became a greater concern. However, the youth of today has the absolute best possible shopping opportunities. Going to ‘mega-malls’ the teenager has an abundance of

specialty and brand-name stores to choose from. Additionally, the browsing and purchasing of clothing is done primarily alone, or with the company of a friend. Additionally, the teenager may pay for the outfit with a credit-card billed to the parents, or cash earned by a job. This diversity of stores, and independent purchasing power is what has given generation Y the greatest shopping opportunity in history.

When a teenager of today thinks of dating, it implies having a steady girl or boyfriend and frequent dates. This form of dating is entirely unique to generation Y, with generations preceding it having entirely different customs for dating. The grandparents of youth today generally started dating at age 17 or 18. A date generally entailed meeting at a public venue such as a school dance, going to a restaurant, or perhaps watching a movie. For the parents of youth today, dating started around age 16. The date was similar to their parents, where they would be driven to a public event by the parents, then picked up at the end of it. The teenagers of today start dating as early as 12. At this age it is not unusual to have unsupervised dates in private places. Examples include watching TV in the date's bedroom or a movie in the livingroom. Additionally, dates may be held at school dances, restaurants or perhaps even amusement parks. The variety and freedom that generation Y has is truly unique. Never before has dating been so open or casual, and that is why the youth of today has it the best.

The final area of consideration that makes generation Y the most fortunate is popular entertainment. For the grandparents of teenagers today, popular entertainment was very limited. Movies existed for the most part, but were silent as well as black and white. Bands were the most common forms of popular entertainment, as they played at dances and public venues. The parents of the teens of today had better opportunity for entertainment with color movies appearing and television becoming popular. Teens today have the best forms of popular

entertainment, mainly because of improvements in technology. With home theater such as big-screen TV's and DVD players becoming popular, many teens can watch cinema quality movies at home. Traditional movie theaters have also improved with stadium seating and digital audio becoming popular. Concerts are also popular, live bands are on constant tours and venues are not too far away from any fan. Television programming is at an all-time high also. With sitcoms, and dramas aimed at a teen audience, kids watch more TV than their parents ever did. This may be considered detrimental, but in fact the youth of today has the absolute best forms of popular entertainment ever.

Generation Y is different as it should be, however this generation has not seen any true hardships, depressions, or anything to make it less than perfect. The teens of today have the best opportunities, whether they want to go out shopping for a new outfit, on a date with their girl or boyfriend or even to find something entertaining to do. In all, this generation has the best of the best and it will be interesting to see if the generations to come can possibly get better.